Jiyoung Lee

Department of Economics, University of Washington

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Education

Ph.D., Economics, University of Washington, Seattle, WA, USA 2021 – 2027 (Expected)

B.A., Economics, Korea University, Seoul, Republic of Korea 2010 – 2015

Employment History

Junior Economist, Bank of Korea 2015 – 2021

- Inflation Analysis Team, Research Department Feb 2015 – Jul 2017
  Contributed to setting the Bank's first point inflation target for 2016 onward; drafted the *Inflation Report*; analyzed and forecast the housing market.
- National Balance Sheet Team, Economic Statistics Department Aug 2017 – Jul 2019
  Implemented the 2015 benchmark revision for gross fixed capital formation (by industry and institutional sector) and the National Balance Sheet using millions of National Tax Service firm-level records; measured total factor productivity.
- Economic Research Division, Busan Branch Aug 2019 – Jul 2021
  Monitored and wrote reports on the regional economy; received the Best Regional Working Paper Award for analyses of the COVID-19 shock and SME financial support (2020Q2, 2020Q4).

Research Interests

Primary: International Macroeconomics, International Finance, Geoeconomics

Secondary: Trade and Industrial Policy, Defense Economics

References

Fabio Ghironi	**Theo Eicher**	**Andrei Zlate**
Paul F. Glaser Professor	Castor Professor	Principal Economist
Department of Economics	Department of Economics	Division of Monetary Affairs
University of Washington	University of Washington	Federal Reserve Board
ghiro@uw.edu	te@uw.edu	Andrei.zlate@frb.gov

Job Market Paper

Reshoring Policies in the Intangible Economy

Abstract: Reshoring policies sacrifice the cost advantages of offshoring for economic security. Yet this trade-off may differ for intangible-intensive offshoring firms: their scalable intangibles lower marginal costs but entail fixed costs paid with foreign labor. How do reshoring policies affect these firms' location choices and Home consumption, output, and welfare? Using a two-country general equilibrium model with heterogeneous firms and endogenous entry, I compare lump-sum subsidies, tax credits, and tariffs. All three policies reduce offshoring and raise Home consumption and transitional welfare, but only subsidies increase output. The Ramsey-optimal mix combines a lump-sum subsidy worth 8.4% of offshoring profits with a 13.1% tariff, raising Home welfare by 4.0%. These gains come from correcting a distortion: offshoring firms and households ignore how their collective demand for foreign labor raises the foreign wage. Reshoring curbs this excess demand by moving production home and replacing high intangible fixed costs abroad with lower domestic ones, raising Home welfare.

– **Presentations**: CEPR-Kiel-Bocconi Best Paper Award Finalist: 2nd Junior Workshop in Geoeconomics (Bocconi University), 2026 Royal Economic Society (Newcastle University), 8th Annual CefES Conference (ETH Zürich), The 3rd Workshop of the East and South-East Asian Macroeconomic Society (HKUST), Midwest International Trade and Theory Conference (Toronto Metropolitan University)

– **Awards**: RES 2026 Annual Conference: Scholars Fund — Rated Excellent by Committee, Royal Economic Society; Henry T. Buechel Memorial Fellowship, University of Washington

Working Papers

The Effect of Intangible Capital on Offshoring

Abstract: This paper analyzes the impact of intangible capital on firms' offshoring decisions, aggregate productivity, and external competitiveness. I develop a two-country offshoring model with endogenous intangible investment that captures its unique scalability in a framework featuring heterogeneous firm entry and exit. The model successfully replicates the key post-GFC U.S. empirical regularities—the coexistence of aggregate productivity gains and real exchange rate appreciation. Following a positive productivity shock, the entry of domestic firms lowers average firm productivity and raises domestic prices, thereby amplifying the Harrod–Balassa–Samuelson effect. Furthermore, incorporating intangibles yields substantially larger aggregate productivity gains than non-intangible models by improving resource allocation. This research contributes by endogenously modeling the scalability of intangible capital—a crucial yet previously understudied factor in offshoring models.

Presentations: 2026 SMU Trade Conference (Singapore Management University), The 18th FIW Research Conference "International Economics" (WU Vienna), Boston College 2nd PhD Conference, HEC Paris Economics PhD Conference (HEC Paris), AEA CSWEP PhD Mentoring Workshop, PhD–EVS

War and Macro (with Fabio Ghironi, University of Washington; Daisoon Kim, North Carolina State University; and Galip Kemal Ozhan, IMF) **[Abstract]**

Work in Progress

AI and Trade (with Sangwoo Park, University of Washington and Bank of Korea)

Research Experience

Research Assistant, National Bureau of Economic Research (NBER) 2025 – 2026
– Supervisor: Professor Fabio Ghironi
– Project: "International Trade and Macroeconomic Dynamics with Sanctions" (NSF Award No. 2317089)

Conferences and Training

World Congress of the Econometric Society, Seoul (Attended) 2025
Journal of International Economics Summer School, University of Oxford (Selected) 2024
AEA CSWEP Mentorship for PhD Students, Washington, DC (Selected; AEA travel grant) 2024
Eurostat Conference on Quality in Official Statistics, Kraków (Attended) 2018

Fellowships, Honors, and Awards

Henry T. Buechel Memorial Fellowship, University of Washington 2026
RES 2026 Annual Conference: Scholars Fund, Royal Economic Society 2026
Graduate Student Conference Presentation Award (×2), University of Washington 2026
The Steven Langton Teaching Award, University of Washington 2024
Travel Award ($3,500), National Science Foundation (via Prof. Fabio Ghironi) 2024
Doctoral Study Abroad Fellowship ($193,920), Bank of Korea 2021 – 2023
– Granted to 6 junior economists annually; providing two years of tuition, living expenses, and salary
Governor's Award (2nd Prize), Bank of Korea Young Economist Research Paper Competition 2016
Inbong Scholarship for Academic Excellence ($11,000), Korea University 2012 – 2013
Scholarship for Superior Academic Performance, Korea University 2011

Policy Papers

Implications of Financial Support for SMEs after COVID-19: Focus on the Busan Area, 2020
Golden Book, *Best Regional Working Paper Place*, Bank of Korea (Korean) **[Paper Link]**
Comparison Between COVID-19 and Past Crises, *Golden Book*, *Best Regional Working Paper* 2020
Place, Bank of Korea (Korean) **[Paper Link]**
Recent Housing Consumption Behavior of the Baby Boomer Generation and Its Implications, 2017
Monthly Bulletin, Bank of Korea **[Paper Link]**
Inflation Target for 2016 Onwards, *Inflation Report*, Bank of Korea 2016
Using Microdata to Reinterpret the Effect of Inflation Expectations on Consumption 2016
(with Heewan Jeong and Youngchul You), *2nd Prize (awarded by the Governor),*
Bank of Korea Young Economist Research Paper Competition
Current Status and Implications of the Inflataion Targeting Countries, *Inflation Report*, 2016
Bank of Korea (Korean) **[Paper Link]**

Presentations

CEPR-Kiel-Bocconi Best Paper Award Finalist: 2nd Junior Workshop in Geoeconomics 2026
(Bocconi University), 2026 Royal Economic Society (Newcastle University, *RES Scholars Fund Recipient*), 8th Annual CefES Conference (ETH Zürich), The 18th FIW Research Conference "International Economics" (WU Vienna), 2026 SMU Trade Conference (Singapore Management University), Boston College 2nd PhD Conference in Economics (Boston College), HEC Paris Economics PhD Conference (HEC Paris), Midwest International Trade and Theory Conference (Toronto Metropolitan University), The 3rd Workshop of the East and South-East Asian Macroeconomic Society (HKUST), PhD – EVS, UW Honors Research Seminar†
AEA CSWEP PhD Mentoring Workshop (Washington, DC) 2024
Macro Brown Bag Seminar & Macro Workshop, University of Washington 2024 –

† Presented by co-author

Teaching Experience

Teaching Assistant, University of Washington *Overall Mean Evaluation: 4.8 / 5.0*
– Intermediate Macroeconomics (Undergraduate, × 2) Spring 2026
– Introductory Macroeconomics (Undergraduate, × 6) 2023 – 2026
– Introductory Microeconomics (Undergraduate, × 2) 2025
Grader, University of Washington
– Topics in Monetary Economics (Prof. Fabio Ghironi) 2022 – 2026
– Advanced Macroeconomics (Prof. Fabio Ghironi) 2024 – 2026
Samsung Dream Class Program Tutor (Korea University Middle School) 2012 – 2013
– Provided mathematics tutoring to students from under-resourced communities

Misc.

Programming: MATLAB, STATA, R, Eviews, and LaTeX
Languages: Korean (native), English (fluent)
Citizenship: Republic of Korea **Gender:** Female